Lesson plan · for the teacher

Ask clearly

AI agents · Level 2 · Lesson 2

Time
40 min

Materials
Paper slips and pens; Five vague requests written on the board (for example “Remind me about the thing”); A sign that says “Agent”

Learning goals

- Write a request with a goal, details, limits and what done looks like.
- Spot what an agent would have to ask or guess.
- Explain why a limit in words needs the app behind it.

Activity: Vague to clear

1. Warm-up (5 min): Read “Remind me about the thing” aloud and ask: what would a helper need to know? Collect the missing details on the board.
2. Teach (8 min): Show the four parts: goal, details, limits, what done looks like. Compare a request with the note you leave for a supply teacher. Stress that a limit in words is a request, and the app must back it up.
3. Vague to clear (15 min): Pairs choose a vague request from the board and rewrite it with all four parts. One pupil holds the “Agent” sign and acts out only what is written; if something is missing, the agent must ask or guess aloud. Swap roles for a second request.
4. Check it (7 min): For each pair, the class says where the agent had to ask or guess, and which part of the request would have prevented it.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Vote for the clearest request of the day and copy it onto the board. Then give the exit ticket.

Write five vague requests on the board before the lesson and make an “Agent” sign. No devices are needed.

Discussion

- Which part of a request do people forget most?
- When is it better for an agent to ask than to guess?
- Why isn’t “don’t send it” enough on its own?

Exit ticket

- Rewrite “Remind me about the meeting” so that an agent can’t get it wrong.

Try it at school tomorrow
Play “Vague to clear”: pupils rewrite a vague request with a goal, details, limits and what done looks like, and a partner plays an agent who does only what is written.

Practice questions · for you

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1 **You ask: "What's the weather tomorrow?" What will a good agent do?**

◯ Guess your village ◯ Ask which village ◯ Give today's weather instead

2 **Which of these make a request clear for an agent? Choose all that apply.**

☐ The goal: what you want done ☐ Who, what, when and where

☐ Polite words, such as "please" ☐ Limits, such as "don't send it yet"

☐ Capital letters, so it notices ☐ What done looks like

3 **Complete the sentence.**

A clear request has a _____, the _____, the _____ and what done looks like.

Word bank: limits · colour · details · goal · greeting

4 **Match each vague request to what the agent would have to ask.**

"Remind me about the meeting."	• • • •	Which parents, and what does the note say?
"Send the note to the parents."	• • • •	When, and which meeting?
"Find books for my class."	• • • •	Which village?
"What's the weather tomorrow?"	• • • •	On what topic?

5 **If you write "don't send anything" in your request, the agent can never send a message.**

◯ True ◯ False

✎ **Write a request you might give an agent this week. Does it have a goal, details, limits and what done looks like? What would the agent still have to guess?**

Check your answers

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1 **Ask which village**

The village is missing, so a good agent asks instead of guessing.

2 **The goal: what you want done; Who, what, when and where; Limits, such as “don’t send it yet”; What done looks like**

The goal, the details, the limits and what done looks like give the agent everything it needs, and give you something to check.

3 **A clear request has a goal, the details, the limits and what done looks like.**

A goal says what to do, details say who, what, when and where, and limits say what not to do.

4 **“Remind me about the meeting.” — When, and which meeting?**
“Send the note to the parents.” — Which parents, and what does the note say?
“Find books for my class.” — On what topic?
“What’s the weather tomorrow?” — Which village?

Each vague request leaves out a detail the agent can’t know: the time, the people, the topic or the place.

5 **False**

A limit in words is a request, not a lock: the model can misread it, and a new wording can slip past.